

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 3

Chapter 16: Turning Tides: 11th and 12th Centuries

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	16 — Turning Tides: 11th and 12th Centuries
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Classic traps: confusing raiding-for-plunder (Mahmud, ~17 raids, withdrew each time) with conquering-to-govern (the Ghurids, Aibak's Sultanate); reversing the Tarain battles (Ghuri LOST the First, 1191; WON the Second, 1192); assuming all of India fell when the south (Cholas, Kakatiyas, Hoysalas) and much of the north stayed free; treating the age as 'only war' when al-Biruni, Bhaskaracharya, Ramanuja, Basava and great temples flourished; and forgetting al-Biruni's learning and India's sine-tables made it two-way. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A textbook timeline marks the 8th-century Arab arrival in Sindh and the 11th-12th-century Turkic invasions as separate waves. The chief reason historians treat the LATER wave as the real 'turning point' is that it:

- (A) was the very first time any outsider reached India
- (B) pushed far deeper into the subcontinent and eventually led to lasting foreign rule, unlike the earlier raids confined near Sindh
- (C) was entirely peaceful and based on trade, unlike the violent Arabs
- (D) restored the Gupta empire across the north

2. Two claims are made: (i) 'The Arabs never went past Sindh' and (ii) 'The Turkic invaders reached deep into north India.' Taken together, these claims best support the conclusion that:

- (A) the depth of penetration, not merely the fact of invasion, is what made the 11th-12th centuries a turning point
- (B) both Arab and Turkic forces conquered the entire subcontinent equally

- (C) neither wave of invaders ever crossed into India
- (D) the Cholas of the south led both invasions

3. The chapter insists this was an age of 'resilience.' Which single piece of evidence best PROVES resilience rather than merely survival?

- (A) every Indian kingdom was destroyed and rebuilt identically
- (B) even as the north faced invasions, scholars, saints and temple-builders kept producing major new work
- (C) the invaders abandoned India and never returned
- (D) all learning paused until the invasions ended

4. A student argues, 'Because India faced repeated invasions, its culture must have collapsed.' The chapter's evidence refutes this MOST directly by pointing to:

- (A) the complete halt of all trade and travel
- (B) the disappearance of every southern kingdom
- (C) the conversion of all of India into Ghaznavid territory
- (D) the simultaneous rise of great scholars, new philosophies and magnificent temples during the same period

5. Invaders repeatedly chose the north-west passes such as the Khyber rather than approaching India by sea. The best explanation rooted in the chapter is that:

- (A) India had no coastline at all in this period
- (B) the passes were Chola naval bases that welcomed invaders
- (C) the north-west mountain passes were long-used overland routes, making the region a recurring gateway for trade and invasion
- (D) the south had no kingdoms worth invading

6. The Hindu Shahis are remembered in connection with the early Turkic invasions chiefly because they:

- (A) ruled the Tamil south and built the Brihadishvara temple
- (B) founded the Delhi Sultanate after the Battles of Tarain
- (C) led naval expeditions to Srivijaya in Southeast Asia
- (D) tried to guard the north-western approaches against the first wave of Turkic invaders

7. If the north-west passes had been impassable mountains with no routes through them, the chapter's logic suggests that:

- (A) the Cholas would have lost their navy
- (B) Mahmud of Ghazni would have ruled all of India
- (C) the overland Turkic invasions would have found it far harder to enter India repeatedly
- (D) al-Biruni would never have learned Sanskrit

8. Calling the north-west India's 'recurring gateway' rather than its 'safest frontier' reflects which judgement?

- (A) the region was sealed off by the sea and never breached
- (B) the region was a southern port that faced no invaders
- (C) the region was repeatedly the point through which invaders entered, so it was a vulnerability, not a shield
- (D) the region protected India better than any other frontier

9. Mahmud of Ghazni led about 17 expeditions into India, yet the chapter denies he 'ruled' India. The decisive reason is that:

- (A) after each raid he carried off plunder and withdrew, never staying to govern the land
- (B) he was defeated every time and never reached India
- (C) he ruled only the south while the north stayed free
- (D) he founded the Delhi Sultanate and governed for life

10. A pupil writes: 'Mahmud destroyed the Brihadishvara temple during his raids.' The correct correction is:

- (A) Mahmud destroyed Angkor Wat, not Brihadishvara
- (B) the statement is correct as written
- (C) Mahmud destroyed Nalanda, which is another name for Brihadishvara
- (D) Mahmud's raids targeted Somnath; Brihadishvara was a Chola temple built by Rajaraja I, untouched by him

11. The word 'plunder' captures Mahmud's purpose better than 'conquest' because plunder means:

- (A) land permanently annexed and then governed
- (B) valuable goods seized by force in a raid, after which the raider departs
- (C) a peace treaty signed between rival kings
- (D) the towering shrine built over a temple's sanctum

12. Which statement best contrasts a 'raider' with a 'conqueror' as the chapter uses the terms?

- (A) a raider always builds a lasting empire; a conqueror never keeps land
- (B) a raider takes treasure and leaves; a conqueror stays to rule the land he takes
- (C) the two words mean exactly the same thing
- (D) a conqueror only raids temples while a raider governs villages

13. If we judged Mahmud only by the treasure he carried home, we would mistakenly conclude that he:

- (A) never entered India at all
- (B) built the temples he visited
- (C) must have ruled India, when in fact wealth from raids does not require holding territory

(D) led the Chola navy across the seas

14. Place these in correct historical sequence: (i) the Ghurids establish lasting rule in north India; (ii) Mahmud of Ghazni's plundering raids; (iii) Aibak founds the Delhi Sultanate.

The correct order is:

- (A) Aibak's Sultanate, then Mahmud's raids, then the Ghurids
- (B) the Ghurids' rule, then Mahmud's raids, then Aibak's Sultanate
- (C) Mahmud's raids, then the Ghurids' lasting rule, then Aibak's Delhi Sultanate
- (D) Mahmud's raids, then Aibak's Sultanate, then the Ghurids

15. The phrase 'from plunder to rule' best summarises a shift in which:

- (A) later invaders, unlike Mahmud, stayed to govern instead of merely looting and leaving
- (B) rulers gave up governing in order to take up raiding
- (C) the Cholas turned from sea power to land raids
- (D) the Hindu Shahis began plundering Ghazni

16. Why does the chapter credit the Ghurids, not Mahmud of Ghazni, with beginning lasting foreign rule in north India?

- (A) Mahmud reached India but the Ghurids never did
- (B) Mahmud governed for centuries while the Ghurids only raided once
- (C) the Ghurids were a southern dynasty that absorbed the Cholas
- (D) the Ghurids and their generals stayed to govern after victory, whereas Mahmud always withdrew with his loot

17. Al-Biruni learning Sanskrit and writing a careful study of India is offered as proof that:

- (A) foreign scholars learned nothing from India
- (B) all Indian learning had stopped during the invasions
- (C) books were no longer written anywhere in the period
- (D) scholarship and curiosity about India continued and flowed both ways even amid invasions

18. The chapter calls the period 'an age of two-way learning.' Which pair of facts together best demonstrates the 'two-way' part?

- (A) al-Biruni destroyed Indian books, while Indians copied foreign ones
- (B) only India learned, taking everything from foreign scholars
- (C) no exchange of any knowledge took place in either direction
- (D) al-Biruni studied India's sciences, while Indian sine tables travelled outward to influence mathematics elsewhere

19. Indian sine tables shaping mathematics beyond India is significant chiefly because it shows that:

- (A) mathematics was entirely unknown within India
- (B) India only ever borrowed and never contributed ideas
- (C) India was a giver, not only a receiver, of knowledge in this period
- (D) Indian knowledge never left the subcontinent

20. A debater claims, 'al-Biruni came with the armies, so his book was just war propaganda.' The best counter from the chapter is that:

- (A) he never actually wrote anything about India
- (B) he refused to study any Indian subject
- (C) he led the destruction of Nalanda and Vikramashila
- (D) he learned Sanskrit and wrote a careful, serious study of India's sciences, religion and customs

21. Al-Biruni's careful study and Bhaskaracharya's mathematics, taken together, refute which single misconception?

- (A) that India ever possessed any mathematics
- (B) that the invasions had brought serious scholarship in and about India to an end
- (C) that the south stayed free of invaders
- (D) that the Cholas built a powerful navy

22. Algebra takes its name from the Arabic 'al-jabr.' Which statement about this term is correct?

- (A) it means 'the cosmic mountain' represented at Angkor Wat
- (B) it means 'a fleet of fighting ships' like the Chola navy
- (C) it means 'reunion of broken parts' and is from the title of al-Khwarizmi's book
- (D) it is the Kannada word for a short devotional poem

23. Trigonometry was vital to the astronomy of this age because it is the mathematics of:

- (A) decorative temple gateways and their carvings
- (B) triangles and angles, which astronomers used to measure positions in the sky
- (C) warships and the sailors who crew them
- (D) short Kannada poems used by saints

24. That both 'algebra' (from Arabic al-jabr) and India's sine tables appear in the chapter together illustrates that mathematics in this age was:

- (A) invented solely in India with no outside contact
- (B) an international enterprise, with ideas and names crossing between cultures
- (C) developed only by Turkic generals on campaign
- (D) abandoned everywhere until the invasions ended

25. If a student matched 'al-jabr' to Mount Meru and 'vimana' to algebra, the correct fix would be:

- (A) al-jabr means a temple tower; vimana means algebra
- (B) both al-jabr and vimana refer to the cosmic mountain

(C) al-jabr is the root of 'algebra' (reunion of broken parts); a vimana is a South Indian temple tower

(D) al-jabr is a Kannada poem; vimana is a fighting ship

26. Bhaskaracharya's career during this period is best used as evidence for which broad claim?

(A) Indian science was entirely a foreign invention

(B) Indian science endured and kept advancing despite the northern invasions

(C) Indian mathematics vanished until the Cholas revived it

(D) science was practised only in the territories Mahmud raided

27. The Kakatiyas of the Deccan are specifically linked to the torana at Warangal. A 'torana' is best understood as:

(A) the tall tower over a temple's main shrine

(B) a decorative stone gateway, a piece of monumental art

(C) a village assembly that governed local affairs

(D) a subordinate ruler who owed loyalty to a king

28. The Kakatiyas building a torana at Warangal and the Hoysalas flourishing in the Deccan together prove that:

(A) the whole of India had fallen to the Turkic invaders

(B) the Deccan was ruled directly from Ghazni (C) the south had no kingdoms of its own

(D) while the north faced invasions, the south remained free and continued to create great works

29. Grouping the Kakatiyas, Hoysalas and Cholas together, the single feature they share in this chapter is that all three were:

(A) Turkic dynasties that entered through the north-west passes

(B) founders of the Delhi Sultanate after Tarain

(C) southern or Deccan Indian powers that flourished while the north faced invasions

(D) Central Asian raiders allied with Mahmud of Ghazni

30. Rajaraja Chola I and Rajendra Chola I are remembered together because both:

(A) raided Somnath and withdrew with plunder

(B) were defeated at the Battles of Tarain

(C) strengthened Chola power, including its navy, and extended the dynasty's reach

(D) founded Buddhist universities like Nalanda

31. Rajendra Chola I's naval expedition to Srivijaya is significant in this chapter mainly because it shows that, while the north faced invasions, the south was:

(A) a far-reaching sea power projecting strength across the Indian Ocean

(B) a landlocked region dependent on the northern passes

- (C) a vassal forced to serve the Ghurid generals
- (D) unaware of any lands beyond its own coast

32. The Brihadishvara temple's soaring vimana, built under Rajaraja Chola I, is best read as evidence that:

- (A) the Cholas built temples only after the Delhi Sultanate fell
- (B) Mahmud of Ghazni sponsored Chola temple-building
- (C) the south had abandoned temple construction by this age
- (D) monumental temple architecture flourished in the free south during this period

33. Which statement correctly distinguishes a 'navy' from a 'vimana'?

- (A) a navy is a country's fighting ships and crews; a vimana is the tower over a temple's shrine
- (B) a navy is a temple tower; a vimana is a fleet of ships
- (C) both terms mean a decorative gateway
- (D) a navy is a Kannada poem; a vimana is a village assembly

34. The Cholas' control of the sea, contrasted with Mahmud's overland raids, illustrates that in this period India's power was:

- (A) split between flourishing maritime southern kingdoms and a north repeatedly raided by overland invaders
- (B) concentrated entirely in Ghazni
- (C) wholly maritime, with no land kingdoms anywhere
- (D) limited to the Hindu Shahis of the north-west

35. The Paramaras are tied to a ruler the chapter calls a 'scholar-king.' This figure is:

- (A) Bhoja, who combined governing with a deep love of learning
- (B) Prithviraj Chauhan, defeated at the Second Battle of Tarain
- (C) Muhammad Ghuri, leader of the Ghurids
- (D) Rajendra Chola I, who sailed to Srivijaya

36. Calling Bhoja a 'scholar-king' rather than simply a 'king' emphasises that he:

- (A) never held any throne or governed any land
- (B) actively championed learning alongside the work of ruling
- (C) was a foreign invader rather than an Indian ruler
- (D) commanded the Chola navy instead of an army

37. Arrange these correctly from earliest to latest: (i) Second Battle of Tarain; (ii) Mahmud of Ghazni's raids; (iii) First Battle of Tarain.

- (A) Mahmud's raids, then the First Battle of Tarain, then the Second Battle of Tarain
- (B) First Battle of Tarain, then Mahmud's raids, then Second Battle of Tarain
- (C) Second Battle of Tarain, then First Battle of Tarain, then Mahmud's raids
- (D) Mahmud's raids, then the Second Battle of Tarain, then the First Battle of Tarain

- 38.** At the First Battle of Tarain (1191) the outcome was that Muhammad Ghuri:
- (A) was defeated by Prithviraj Chauhan, only to return and win the following year
 - (B) defeated Prithviraj Chauhan and at once conquered all India
 - (C) was killed, ending the Ghurid threat permanently
 - (D) was helped to victory by the Chola navy
- 39.** The Second Battle of Tarain (1192) is treated as a hinge of the period because Muhammad Ghuri's victory there:
- (A) ended in his defeat and his permanent retreat from India
 - (B) destroyed the Chola navy in the south
 - (C) opened the way to lasting foreign rule, soon formalised in the Delhi Sultanate
 - (D) led directly to Mahmud of Ghazni's first raid
- 40.** Which single correction fixes the claim, 'Prithviraj Chauhan won both Battles of Tarain'?
- (A) he won the First (1191) but lost the Second (1192) to Muhammad Ghuri
 - (B) he lost both battles to Muhammad Ghuri
 - (C) he won both battles, exactly as stated
 - (D) he fought both battles at sea against the Cholas
- 41.** Keeping the Tarain battles straight matters because reversing them would wrongly imply that:
- (A) Mahmud of Ghazni fought at Tarain
 - (B) Prithviraj's resistance failed first in 1191 and then succeeded in 1192, hiding the real path to Ghurid rule
 - (C) the Cholas decided the battles
 - (D) the battles occurred before the Arab arrival in Sindh
- 42.** Qutb-ud-din Aibak's role is best summarised as:
- (A) a Chola admiral who sailed to Srivijaya
 - (B) a Ghurid general who, after the conquest, founded the Delhi Sultanate
 - (C) the scholar who wrote a careful study of India
 - (D) the saint who founded the Lingayat movement
- 43.** A 'Sultanate' is best defined, in this chapter's sense, as:
- (A) a decorative stone gateway in a temple complex
 - (B) a hall where people of all backgrounds exchanged ideas
 - (C) a short devotional poem in Kannada
 - (D) the rule or territory of a sultan
- 44.** Bakhtiyar Khilji is remembered in the chapter chiefly for an act that the text treats as a serious loss to learning, namely:
- (A) founding the Chola navy in the south
 - (B) writing the Rajatarangini
 - (C) destroying the great Buddhist universities of Nalanda and Vikramashila
 - (D) building the Brihadishvara temple

45. The destruction of Nalanda and Vikramashila is described as especially damaging because these were:

- (A) Chola naval bases guarding the southern coast
- (B) Turkic frontier forts in the north-west
- (C) Tamil trading ports on the Coromandel coast
- (D) great centres of learning - Buddhist universities - so their loss struck at knowledge itself

46. Pairing Aibak with Bakhtiyar Khilji, the chapter uses them to illustrate two faces of the conquest, namely that it:

- (A) left both governance and learning entirely unchanged
- (B) built new political rule (the Sultanate) while also destroying old centres of learning (the universities)
- (C) only raided for treasure and never governed anything
- (D) served the Cholas and expanded their navy

47. Ramanujacharya's philosophy, Vishishtadvaita, is best summarised as the teaching that:

- (A) the world is wholly unreal and must be denied
- (B) ritual sacrifice by itself sets the soul free
- (C) the world and individual souls are real, with bhakti and surrender to God as the path to liberation
- (D) there are no gods of any kind

48. Basavanna's Lingayat movement is described as rejecting caste and ritual. The institution he set up to embody this openness was the:

- (A) Delhi Sultanate, the seat of a sultan's rule
- (B) torana, a decorative ceremonial gateway
- (C) Chola navy, a fleet open to all recruits
- (D) Anubhava mandapa, a hall where people of all backgrounds met to exchange ideas

49. A 'vachana,' the form Basavanna used, is:

- (A) a short Kannada poem expressing spiritual and ethical ideas
- (B) the towering shrine of a South Indian temple
- (C) a fleet of fighting ships
- (D) a decorative stone gateway

50. Ramanuja's bhakti teaching and Basava's Lingayat movement are placed together in the chapter mainly to show that this age:

- (A) produced no religious thought of any kind
- (B) was occupied only by war and destruction
- (C) saw all spiritual life replaced by foreign rule
- (D) produced influential new religious thinkers and devotional movements even amid the invasions

- 51.** That the Lingayats welcomed all to the Anubhava mandapa while rejecting caste shows the movement valued, above all:
- (A) equality and the open exchange of ideas across social backgrounds
 - (B) strict caste hierarchy in worship
 - (C) the supremacy of a single sultan over all
 - (D) the military conquest of the south
- 52.** Khajuraho and Brihadishvara are cited side by side to argue that, in this period, India was:
- (A) wholly given over to warfare with no building at all
 - (B) ruled in every region from Ghazni
 - (C) rich in temple art and architecture across different regions
 - (D) stripped of all artistic activity
- 53.** Angkor Wat in Cambodia is brought into a chapter on India because its five towers symbolise Mount Meru, showing that:
- (A) India had conquered and ruled Cambodia by force
 - (B) Indian cultural and religious ideas spread peacefully far beyond India's borders
 - (C) Cambodia had invaded and ruled India
 - (D) India possessed no temples of its own in this age
- 54.** The five towers of Angkor Wat are said to represent Mount Meru, which is:
- (A) a fortress built by Mahmud of Ghazni
 - (B) the largest of the Chola warships
 - (C) a Buddhist university like Nalanda
 - (D) the cosmic mountain at the centre of the universe in Indian cosmology
- 55.** The grand temples within India together with India's influence on Angkor Wat best support the conclusion that the period's India was:
- (A) a thriving cultural centre whose art and ideas radiated well beyond its borders
 - (B) artistically barren and culturally isolated
 - (C) entirely ruled by the invaders in every region
 - (D) a place where temple-building had been forbidden
- 56.** Distinguishing a 'vimana' from a 'torana,' the correct statement is:
- (A) a vimana is a gateway; a torana is the shrine tower
 - (B) both are types of warship
 - (C) a vimana is a Kannada poem; a torana is a sultan's realm
 - (D) a vimana is the tower over a temple's main shrine; a torana is a decorative gateway
- 57.** A student claims, 'Since the whole of India fell to the Turkic invaders, every kingdom was destroyed.' The chapter best refutes this by pointing out that:
- (A) much of the north and all of the south stayed free, with the Cholas, Kakatiyas and Hoysalas flourishing
 - (B) there were no invaders in the period at all

- (C) the invaders conquered literally every region
- (D) only the southern coast was ever invaded

58. Which combination correctly pairs each figure with his defining action?

- (A) Mahmud founded the Sultanate; Ghuri only raided; Aibak sailed to Srivijaya
- (B) Mahmud ruled the south; Ghuri built Angkor Wat; Aibak wrote on algebra
- (C) Mahmud raided for plunder; Muhammad Ghuri came to stay and rule; Aibak founded the Delhi Sultanate
- (D) Mahmud led the Chola navy; Ghuri destroyed Nalanda; Aibak defended the Khyber Pass

59. A friend says: 'The 11th-12th centuries were nothing but invasion and ruin.' The strongest single rebuttal draws on:

- (A) the scholars (al-Biruni, Bhaskaracharya), thinker-saints (Ramanuja, Basava) and temples (Khajuraho, Brihadishvara, Angkor Wat's Indian influence) of the same age
- (B) the fact that no invasions actually occurred
- (C) the claim that the south too was conquered and ruined
- (D) the idea that all learning ceased until the 13th century

60. A pupil writes three claims: 'Mahmud ruled all India,' 'the whole subcontinent fell,' and 'nothing of value was created.' How many are correct, and what is the best single correction?

- (A) all three are correct as written
- (B) none are correct: Mahmud only raided, much of India stayed free, and the age produced great scholars, saints and temples
- (C) only the first is wrong; the other two are correct
- (D) only the third is wrong; Mahmud did rule all India

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 16: Turning Tides: 11th and 12th Centuries — Paper 3

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	B	11	B	21	B	31	A	41	B	51	A
2	A	12	B	22	C	32	D	42	B	52	C
3	B	13	C	23	B	33	A	43	D	53	B
4	D	14	C	24	B	34	A	44	C	54	D
5	C	15	A	25	C	35	A	45	D	55	A
6	D	16	D	26	B	36	B	46	B	56	D
7	C	17	D	27	B	37	A	47	C	57	A
8	C	18	D	28	D	38	A	48	D	58	C
9	A	19	C	29	C	39	C	49	A	59	A
10	D	20	D	30	C	40	A	50	D	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (B) The Arabs had already reached Sindh centuries earlier, so the Turkic wave was not the 'first' arrival. The Turkic invasions are the turning point precisely because they penetrated much deeper and finally produced lasting rule (the Ghurids and the Delhi Sultanate), whereas the Arab raids stayed near Sindh. The idea that it was peaceful trade is false - these were invasions; and the Guptas were long gone and were not restored.

2. (A) Both claims are true and together they show that what changed was how FAR the invaders reached - the Turkic wave went deep while the Arabs stayed near Sindh - making depth the key to the 'turning point.' Neither wave conquered the whole subcontinent (the south stayed free), both did cross into India, and the Cholas were a southern Indian power, not invaders.

3. (B) Resilience means bouncing back and continuing to flourish, not just barely surviving. The strongest evidence is the continued flowering of scholarship (al-Biruni, Bhaskaracharya), devotional thought (Ramanuja, Basava) and temple art DURING the

invasions. The other options are either false (kingdoms were not all destroyed; invaders did return repeatedly) or describe a pause in learning, which is the opposite of resilience.

4. (D) The claim of cultural collapse is refuted by what was actually CREATED during the period: al-Biruni's and Bhaskaracharya's scholarship, Ramanuja's and Basava's philosophies, and temples from Khajuraho to Brihadishvara. The distractors assert collapse (halted trade, vanished kingdoms, total Ghaznavid rule) - none of which happened; the south flourished and Mahmud only raided.

5. (C) The Khyber and similar passes through the Hindu Kush were established overland trade-and-invasion routes, so the north-west became the recurring entry point. India certainly had a long coastline (the Cholas were a sea power); the passes were mountain routes, not Chola naval bases; and the south did have powerful kingdoms - it simply was not reached by these overland invaders.

6. (D) The Hindu Shahis defended the north-western frontier - the very region the passes opened up - against the early Turkic invaders. They did not rule the Tamil south (the Cholas did, and built Brihadishvara), did not found the Sultanate (Aibak did, later), and did not sail to Srivijaya (Rajendra Chola did).

7. (C) Since the passes were the gateway for overland invaders, sealing them would have made repeated entry far harder - this follows directly from the chapter's emphasis on the north-west as the route in. The Chola navy was a southern sea matter unaffected by northern passes; Mahmud only raided regardless; and al-Biruni's Sanskrit study did not depend on the passes being open.

8. (C) A 'gateway' that invaders kept using is a point of vulnerability, the opposite of a 'safe' frontier - hence it is not described as the safest. The north-west was a land frontier, not sea-sealed; it was in the north, not a southern port; and far from protecting India best, it was the very route invaders exploited.

9. (A) Ruling requires staying to govern; Mahmud instead seized booty and returned to Ghazni after each of his roughly 17 raids, so he raided but did not rule. He did reach India (repeatedly) and was not defeated every time; he ruled neither the south nor the north; and the Delhi Sultanate was founded later by Aibak, a Ghurid general.

10. (D) The famous temple sacked in Mahmud's raids was Somnath; Brihadishvara was the great Chola temple of Rajaraja I in the far south, beyond Mahmud's reach. Angkor Wat is in Cambodia and was not attacked by Mahmud; the original statement is therefore wrong; and Nalanda was a Buddhist university (later destroyed by Bakhtiyar Khilji), not another name for any temple.

11. (B) Plunder is loot - valuables grabbed by force, with the raider then leaving - which matches Mahmud's pattern exactly, unlike 'conquest' which implies keeping and governing

land. A treaty is an agreement, not loot; and the tower over a temple's sanctum is a vimana, an unrelated term.

12. (B) The core distinction is leaving versus staying-to-rule: raiders (like Mahmud) carry off loot and withdraw, while conquerors (like the Ghurids) keep and govern the land. A raider does NOT build an empire (that is what distinguishes him); the words are not synonyms; and the last option simply scrambles the roles.

13. (C) Great wealth could tempt one to assume rule, but plunder is collected by raiding and leaving - holding territory is not needed to loot - so the wealth alone does not prove rule (and he did not rule). He clearly entered India repeatedly; he sacked rather than built temples; and he had nothing to do with the Chola navy.

14. (C) Mahmud's Ghaznavid raids came first (early 11th century); the Ghurids later defeated Prithviraj (Tarain, 1192) and stayed to rule; and Aibak, a Ghurid general, then founded the Delhi Sultanate. The other orders place Aibak or the Ghurids before Mahmud, or put Aibak before the Ghurid victory that made his Sultanate possible - all out of sequence.

15. (A) 'From plunder to rule' marks the move from Mahmud's loot-and-leave raiding to the Ghurids' staying-to-govern - the very transition the chapter highlights. It is not a shift from ruling to raiding; the Cholas remained a sea power; and the Hindu Shahis defended the frontier rather than plundering Ghazni.

16. (D) Lasting rule began with the Ghurids because they stayed and governed (Aibak's Sultanate followed), unlike Mahmud who repeatedly withdrew. Both reached India; Mahmud did not govern (he raided), so the roles are not reversed; and the Ghurids came through the north-west, not from the south, and did not absorb the Cholas.

17. (D) Al-Biruni mastering Sanskrit to study Indian sciences, religion and customs shows that learning continued and was two-way - foreigners studied India even as Indian ideas spread out. This directly contradicts the claims that foreigners learned nothing, that Indian learning stopped, or that no books were written.

18. (D) Two-way learning needs flow in BOTH directions: a foreigner (al-Biruni) studying India, AND Indian knowledge (sine tables) spreading abroad - exactly the pairing given. The other options describe destruction, one-way borrowing, or no exchange at all, none of which is 'two-way.'

19. (C) Sine tables travelling outward proves India exported knowledge - it gave as well as received - which is the point of the example. India clearly knew mathematics (Bhaskaracharya, the sine tables themselves); it did contribute, not merely borrow; and its knowledge plainly did leave the subcontinent.

20. (D) The counter is that al-Biruni did the genuine scholarly work of learning Sanskrit and carefully studying India - the mark of real inquiry, not propaganda. He certainly did write a study (so 'never wrote anything' is false), he did not refuse to study India, and the destruction of Nalanda and Vikramashila was the work of Bakhtiyar Khilji, not al-Biruni.

21. (B) A foreign scholar studying India (al-Biruni) and an Indian advancing mathematics (Bhaskaracharya) together prove scholarship continued, refuting the idea that learning ended. They do not bear on whether India had mathematics (it clearly did), nor on the south's freedom or the Chola navy, which are separate, true facts.

22. (C) 'Al-jabr' means 'reunion of broken parts,' from al-Khwarizmi's book, and gives us the word 'algebra.' The cosmic mountain is Mount Meru; a fleet of ships is a navy; and a short Kannada devotional poem is a vachana - each an unrelated term from elsewhere in the chapter.

23. (B) Trigonometry deals with triangles and angles, the very tools astronomers needed to chart the heavens - hence its importance. Gateways (toranas), warships (a navy) and Kannada poems (vachanas) are unrelated terms drawn from other parts of the chapter.

24. (B) An Arabic-named technique (algebra) and an Indian export (sine tables) appearing side by side show mathematics crossing cultures - an international enterprise. It was not purely Indian and isolated, was not the work of generals, and certainly was not abandoned - Bhaskaracharya was advancing it.

25. (C) 'Al-jabr' (reunion of broken parts) gives 'algebra'; a 'vimana' is the tall tower over a South Indian temple's shrine - the student had swapped them. Mount Meru is the cosmic mountain (linked to Angkor Wat), a vachana is the Kannada poem and a navy is the fleet of ships, so the other options just mislabel everything.

26. (B) A great Indian mathematician-astronomer flourishing during the invasions shows Indian science endured and advanced - the chapter's resilience theme. His work was Indian, not a foreign invention; mathematics did not vanish; and science was not confined to raided areas - the free south was a major centre of learning too.

27. (B) A torana is an ornamental gateway, the kind the Kakatiyas built at Warangal - evidence of southern art flourishing. The tower over a shrine is a vimana; a village assembly is a sabha; and a subordinate ruler is a samanta - distinct terms students may confuse.

28. (D) Active southern dynasties building monuments prove the south stayed free and creative even as the north was invaded. This refutes the claims that all India fell, that the Deccan was Ghazni-ruled (Mahmud only raided the north-west and withdrew), or that the south lacked kingdoms - the Kakatiyas and Hoysalas were exactly such kingdoms.

29. (C) The Kakatiyas, Hoysalas and Cholas were all Indian powers of the south and Deccan that thrived during the period - the common thread. None were Turkic invaders, none founded the Delhi Sultanate (Aibak did), and none were Central Asian raiders allied with Mahmud.

30. (C) Rajaraja built powerful Chola sea power and the Brihadishvara temple, and Rajendra extended Chola reach by sea to Srivijaya - together they show a flourishing southern dynasty. Neither raided Somnath (Mahmud did), neither fought at Tarain (Prithviraj and Ghuri did), and neither founded Nalanda.

31. (A) Sailing all the way to Srivijaya in Southeast Asia shows the Cholas were a powerful maritime force reaching far overseas - southern strength independent of the north. They were not landlocked, not Ghurid vassals, and clearly aware of distant lands they could reach by sea.

32. (D) A towering Chola temple shows grand architecture thriving in the independent south during the period. The Cholas built it well before the Sultanate (Aibak's Sultanate came later in the north); Mahmud, who raided temples, did not sponsor Chola building; and far from abandoning temples, the south was producing some of its greatest ones.

33. (A) A navy is the war-fleet (the Cholas had a strong one); a vimana is the tall tower over a South Indian temple's main shrine (as at Brihadishvara) - the option states both correctly. The others swap the two, conflate them with a torana (gateway), or mislabel them as a vachana (poem) or sabha (assembly).

34. (A) The contrast shows two different theatres: a strong maritime south (Cholas) and a north hit by overland raiders - power was split, not unified under any single force. It was not concentrated in Ghazni (Mahmud withdrew there but did not rule India), not wholly maritime (there were many land kingdoms), and not limited to the Hindu Shahis.

35. (A) Bhoja of the Paramaras was the scholar-king who united ruling with scholarship. Prithviraj Chauhan was the king defeated at Tarain, Muhammad Ghuri led the Ghurid invaders, and Rajendra Chola was the southern naval king - none described as the Paramara scholar-king.

36. (B) The label 'scholar-king' stresses that Bhoja paired ruling with a genuine devotion to scholarship. He did rule (so 'never held a throne' is wrong), he was an Indian Paramara king rather than a foreign invader, and he had no connection to the Chola navy.

37. (A) Mahmud's raids fall in the early 11th century; the First Battle of Tarain was 1191 and the Second was 1192. So the order is raids, then First, then Second. The other sequences either put a Tarain battle before Mahmud's raids or reverse the two battles (1192 cannot precede 1191).

38. (A) Ghuri LOST the First Battle of Tarain (1191) to Prithviraj, then returned to win the Second (1192) - the classic trap is to reverse them. He did not win in 1191 or conquer all India then, was not killed (he came back the next year), and the Cholas, a distant southern sea power, had no part in these northern land battles.

39. (C) Ghuri's win in 1192 broke Prithviraj's resistance and led to lasting Ghurid rule, soon the Delhi Sultanate under Aibak - hence a hinge. He won, not lost, in 1192; the Chola navy was untouched by a northern land battle; and Mahmud's raids came long BEFORE 1192, not after.

40. (A) Prithviraj won the First (1191) but lost the Second (1192) - so the 'both' claim is half right and must be corrected to one win and one loss. He did not lose both (he won the first), the original 'won both' is wrong, and these were land battles in the north, not sea battles against the Cholas.

41. (B) Reversing the battles would make it seem Prithviraj failed first and then beat back the Ghurids - obscuring how the 1192 defeat actually opened the way to Ghurid rule. The reversal has nothing to do with Mahmud (a Ghaznavid, not a Tarain combatant), the Cholas, or the much earlier Arab arrival in Sindh.

42. (B) Aibak, Muhammad Ghuri's general, established the Delhi Sultanate, turning conquest into lasting rule. The Srivijaya voyage was Rajendra Chola's, the careful study of India was al-Biruni's, and the Lingayat movement was Basavanna's - none of which were Aibak's deeds.

43. (D) A sultanate is the realm or rule of a sultan, the form of governance Aibak set up at Delhi. A decorative gateway is a torana; an ideas-hall is the Anubhava mandapa; and a short Kannada poem is a vachana - all unrelated terms.

44. (C) Bakhtiyar Khilji destroyed Nalanda and Vikramashila, a heavy blow to centres of learning. He did not found the Chola navy (a southern Indian achievement), did not write the Rajatarangini, and did not build Brihadishvara (Rajaraja Chola did).

45. (D) Nalanda and Vikramashila were renowned Buddhist universities, so destroying them was a blow to learning - the chapter's point about the cost of the invasions. They were not naval bases, frontier forts or trading ports.

46. (B) Aibak founding the Sultanate and Bakhtiyar Khilji destroying the universities together show the conquest both created new rule and destroyed old learning. It did not leave things unchanged, it did go beyond mere raiding to governance (unlike Mahmud), and it had nothing to do with serving the Cholas.

47. (C) Vishishtadvaita holds that the world and souls are real and that loving devotion (bhakti) and surrender lead to liberation. It does not declare the world unreal, does not make ritual sacrifice the sole path, and does not deny the gods.

48. (D) Basavanna's Anubhava mandapa was a hall in which people of every background could meet and share ideas, embodying his rejection of caste. The Delhi Sultanate was Aibak's political creation, a torana is a gateway, and the Chola navy is a war-fleet - none of them Basava's institution.

49. (A) A vachana is a short Kannada poem; Basavanna used vachanas to share his message of devotion and equality. A temple's tower is a vimana, a fleet is a navy, and a gateway is a torana - other terms students may mix up.

50. (D) Ramanuja and Basava together demonstrate vibrant new religious thought during the period - part of the resilience theme. This refutes the claims that there was no religious thought, that the age was only war, or that spiritual life was simply replaced by foreign rule.

51. (A) Welcoming people of every background to share ideas, while rejecting caste, marks equality and open dialogue as the movement's core values. It did not uphold caste hierarchy, did not promote rule by a sultan, and was a spiritual-social movement, not a campaign of conquest.

52. (C) Two great temple complexes from different regions show the period's flourishing temple art and architecture. This contradicts the ideas that there was only warfare and no building, that India was Ghazni-ruled (Mahmud only raided), or that art had ceased.

53. (B) Angkor Wat's towers evoking Mount Meru, the cosmic mountain, show Indian ideas reaching Cambodia through cultural influence, not conquest. India did not conquer Cambodia, Cambodia did not rule India, and India had many great temples of its own (Khajuraho, Brihadishvara).

54. (D) Mount Meru is the cosmic mountain of Indian cosmology, symbolised by Angkor Wat's five towers - evidence of India's cultural reach. It is not a Ghaznavid fortress, a Chola warship, or a university like Nalanda.

55. (A) Magnificent home temples plus influence abroad (Angkor Wat) show India as a flourishing, outward-reaching cultural centre. It was neither barren nor isolated, was not ruled everywhere by invaders (the south stayed free), and certainly did not forbid temple-building.

56. (D) A vimana is the tall tower above a temple's main shrine (as at Brihadishvara); a torana is an ornamental gateway (as at Warangal) - the option states both correctly. The others swap them, call them warships, or mislabel them as a vachana (poem) and a sultanate (a sultan's realm).

57. (A) The claim is false because large parts of the north and all of the south remained free, with thriving southern dynasties - so not every kingdom fell. There certainly were

invaders (so 'no invaders' is wrong), they did not conquer every region, and it was the north, not only the south, that mainly faced them.

58. (C) Mahmud raided and withdrew, the Ghurids (Muhammad Ghuri) came to govern, and Aibak founded the Delhi Sultanate - the only fully correct chain. The other options scramble deeds: Mahmud did not found the Sultanate or rule the south, Aibak did not sail to Srivijaya (Rajendra Chola did) or write on algebra, Ghuri did not build Angkor Wat, Nalanda was destroyed by Bakhtiyar Khilji, and the Khyber was guarded by the Hindu Shahis.

59. (A) The age's scholars, saints and temples - all flourishing during the invasions - directly disprove 'nothing but ruin.' Invasions did occur (so denying them is wrong), the south was not conquered (it flourished), and learning did not cease - al-Biruni, Bhaskaracharya and others were active throughout.

60. (B) All three claims are false: Mahmud merely raided (lasting rule came later under the Ghurids), much of the north and all the south stayed free, and the period was rich in scholarship, devotion and temple art. The other options accept one or more of the three misconceptions - including the false notion that Mahmud ruled India - and so are wrong.